

MiniMax Group (0100.HK)

Takeaways from Founder/CEO meeting: Pursuing ultimate price-to-performance; reiterate Buy

0100.HK

12m Price Target: **HK\$860.00**Price: **HK\$199.30**Upside: **331.5%**

We attended an analyst meeting hosted by MiniMax Founder & CEO Dr. Yan Junjie and the management team at its Shanghai headquarters on July 23. Key topics discussed include the company's top focus in pursuing the best price-to-performance for each of its models, its relative early-mover in building out computing infrastructure amongst independent AI labs, the latest LLM industry landscape and rising importance of 'price' alongside 'performance' and agentic/industry capabilities, and the company's multi-modal approach a key differentiation.

1) The company's top focus in pursuing the best price-to-performance for its models, in particular with M3 model currently at trillions of daily tokens at healthy gross margins for its open platform/API revenues (targeting eventual high double-digits GPM driven by inference efficiencies, at current pricing) and the company expectations that its upcoming M3 Pro (at the 3 trillion parameter size class, targeting launch in Sep-Oct 2026) will have significant cost efficiencies vs. comparable models of its class. MiniMax Sparse Attention, activated parameters and KV Cache optimization were mentioned as drivers.

2) Its early-mover in building out computing infrastructure amongst independent AI labs: the company believes its decision to significantly ramp up self-operated computing (via. acquiring/long-term renting domestically and globally) since Sep 2025 as an advantage amongst peers, when GPUs/AI servers were at much lower long-term rental prices vs. today and will be one of the key drivers of its cost competitiveness via. attractive hardware/rental prices and at high utilization/efficiency (e.g. training+inferencing in a same cluster) given its years of experience in self-operating AI infrastructure.

3) LLM industry landscape and rising importance of 'price' alongside 'performance' and agentic/sector-specific

BUY

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Key Data

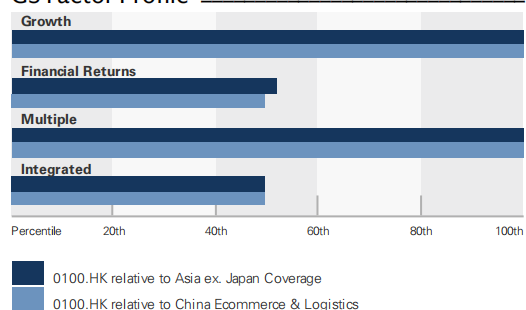
Market cap: HK\$62.5bn / \$8.0bn
Enterprise value: HK\$56.1bn / \$7.2bn
3m ADTV: HK\$1.5bn / \$191.5mn
China
China Ecommerce & Logistics
M&A Rank
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue (\$ mn)	79.0	300.0	880.1	2,469.6
EBITDA (\$ mn)	(294.7)	(452.5)	(518.8)	(396.7)
EPS (\$)	(2.31)	(1.35)	(1.48)	(1.08)
P/E (X)	NM	NM	NM	NM
P/B (X)	NM	NM	NM	NM
Dividend yield (%)	NM	NM	NM	NM
N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	—	—	—	—
CROCI (%)	NM	NM	NM	NM
FCF yield (%)	—	(3.6)	(6.3)	(3.4)

	6/25	12/25	6/26E	12/26E
EPS (\$)	(1.38)	(0.93)	(1.69)	(2.14)

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
See disclosures for details.

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BUY

MiniMax Group (0100.HK)

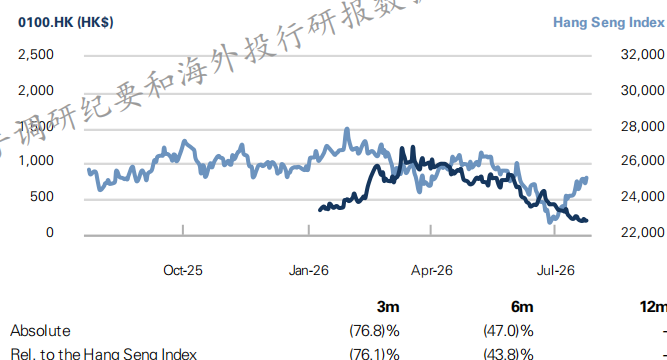
Rating since May 4, 2026

Ratios & Valuation

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
P/E (X)	NM	NM	NM	NM
P/B (X)	NM	NM	NM	NM
FCF yield (%)	—	(3.6)	(6.3)	(3.4)
EV/EBITDAR (X)	—	NM	NM	NM
EV/EBITDA (excl. leases) (X)	—	NM	NM	NM
CROCI (%)	NM	NM	NM	NM
ROE (%)	NM	NM	NM	NM
Net debt/equity (%)	18.3	33.3	10.3	0.4
Net debt/equity (excl. leases) (%)	18.4	33.4	10.5	0.7
Interest cover (X)	(442.5)	(1,713.9)	(794.3)	(421.5)
Days inventory outst, sales	—	—	—	—
Receivable days	40.9	40.9	40.9	40.9
Days payable outstanding	337.1	206.3	118.7	94.1
DuPont ROE (%)	9.5	17.3	16.2	10.7
Turnover (X)	0.1	0.2	0.6	1.4
Leverage (X)	NM	NM	NM	NM
Gross cash invested (ex cash) (\$)	(3,187.6)	(3,323.0)	(3,282.8)	(3,359.6)
Average capital employed (\$)	(2,094.6)	(3,189.4)	(3,238.4)	(3,252.4)
BVPS (\$)	(24.37)	(7.82)	(9.15)	(10.05)

Growth & Margins (%)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue growth	158.9	279.6	193.3	180.6
EBITDA growth	(6.0)	(53.6)	(14.7)	23.5
EPS growth	(2.7)	41.4	(9.3)	27.1
DPS growth	NM	NM	NM	NM
EBIT margin	(376.2)	(151.8)	(59.4)	16.3
EBITDA margin	(372.8)	(150.8)	(59.0)	16.1
Net income margin	(317.4)	(141.5)	(53.8)	14.2

Price Performance**Income Statement (\$ mn)**

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue	79.0	300.0	880.1	2,469.6
Cost of goods sold	(59.0)	(221.9)	(666.3)	(1,624.7)
SG&A	(88.7)	(134.8)	(259.4)	(530.5)
R&D	(252.8)	(467.6)	(549.5)	(791.8)
Other operating inc./exp.)	24.0	68.9	72.3	75.9
EBITDA	(294.7)	(452.5)	(518.8)	(396.7)
Depreciation & amortization	(2.7)	(2.9)	(3.9)	(4.8)
EBIT	(297.4)	(455.4)	(522.8)	(401.5)
Net interest inc./exp.)	(0.7)	(0.3)	(0.7)	(1.0)
Income/(loss) from associates	—	—	—	—
Pre-tax profit	(257.7)	(424.5)	(473.5)	(351.9)
Provision for taxes	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Preferred dividends	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	(250.9)	(424.5)	(473.5)	(351.9)
Post-tax exceptionals	(1,620.8)	(68.9)	(72.3)	(75.9)
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	(1,871.6)	(493.4)	(545.8)	(427.8)
EPS (basic, pre-exception) (\$)	(2.31)	(1.35)	(1.48)	(1.08)
EPS (diluted, pre-exception) (\$)	(2.31)	(1.35)	(1.48)	(1.08)
EPS (basic, post-exception) (\$)	(17.23)	(1.57)	(1.71)	(1.31)
EPS (diluted, post-exception) (\$)	(17.23)	(1.57)	(1.71)	(1.31)
DPS (\$)	—	—	—	—
Div. payout ratio (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0

Balance Sheet (\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Cash & cash equivalents	507.6	1,041.1	727.6	543.8
Accounts receivable	10.7	56.5	140.7	412.7
Inventory	—	—	—	—
Other current assets	489.0	502.7	560.7	719.7
Total current assets	1,007.4	1,600.3	1,429.0	1,676.2
Net PP&E	3.9	5.3	6.5	7.4
Net intangibles	—	—	—	—
Total investments	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Other long-term assets	77.1	79.2	85.0	100.9
Total assets	1,088.4	1,684.8	1,520.5	1,784.5
Accounts payable	57.7	193.3	240.2	597.2
Short-term debt	35.8	235.5	435.5	535.5
Short-term lease liabilities	1.3	1.5	2.4	3.3
Other current liabilities	3,639.2	3,702.9	3,762.9	3,919.4
Total current liabilities	3,733.6	4,133.1	4,441.0	5,055.4
Long-term debt	—	—	—	—
Long-term lease liabilities	0.6	2.3	3.6	5.0
Other long-term liabilities	2.3	2.3	2.3	2.3
Total long-term liabilities	3.0	4.6	5.9	7.3
Total liabilities	3,736.6	4,137.7	4,446.9	5,062.7
Preferred shares	—	—	—	—
Total common equity	(2,648.2)	(2,452.7)	(2,926.2)	(3,278.0)
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Total liabilities & equity	1,088.4	1,684.8	1,520.5	1,784.5
Net debt, adjusted	(486.0)	(819.4)	(306.0)	(22.1)

Cash Flow (\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net income	(1,871.6)	(493.4)	(545.8)	(427.8)
D&A add-back	2.7	2.9	3.9	4.8
Minority interest add-back	—	—	—	—
Net (inc)/dec working capital	6.3	137.6	(41.0)	66.7
Other operating cash flow	1,583.0	69.1	73.0	76.9
Cash flow from operations	(279.6)	(283.7)	(509.8)	(279.5)
Capital expenditures	(0.9)	(1.5)	(1.8)	(2.1)
Acquisitions	(2,207.1)	—	—	—
Divestitures	4,865.2	—	—	—
Others	(13.7)	—	—	—
Cash flow from investing	72.3	(1.5)	(1.8)	(2.1)
Repayment of lease liabilities	(2.2)	(1.1)	(1.2)	(1.3)
Dividends paid (common & pref)	—	—	—	—
Inc/(dec) in debt	15.5	199.7	199.3	99.0
Other financing cash flows	427.5	620.0	0.0	0.0
Cash flow from financing	426.1	818.6	198.2	97.8
Total cash flow	246.5	533.5	(313.5)	(183.8)
Free cash flow	(282.8)	(286.3)	(512.8)	(282.9)

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

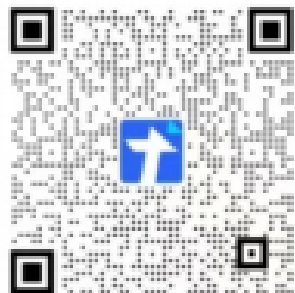
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capabilities: the company commented that their M2 model series outperformed peers in time-to-market and on price-to-performance earlier this year, but acknowledged its upcoming M3 Pro has lagged slightly as the company pursued a two-model within the M3 family and as the company was ramping up its self-operated computing clusters over 1Q26. With Chinese players' focused on post training data and reinforcement learning that is bringing coding performance uplift across the board (where MiniMax is focusing on as well), the company believes user switching between models can be fast and sees pricing/cost efficiencies/speed to become other drivers to user adoption amongst the handful of 3 trillions parameter sizes models to be launched from Chinese players over the next few months.

4) Multi-modal approach as a key differentiation, where the company continues to iterate/refine M3 multi-modal capabilities that will be applied to M3 Pro. Meanwhile, its upcoming H3 model will be more than a video-generation model (Hailuo) but a new architecture as an Omni-model, that understands all modals (text, image, video, audio, music) with stable output across video, image, audio based on user needs/prompts. The company expects imminent launch of its H3 model (that is in its final stages of launch preparations) with implications to the multi-modal industry landscape (offering alternatives to existing video generation products).

Implications: We view multiple positive share price drivers from here; positive skewed risk-reward

With MiniMax eligible for Southbound Connect from Aug 2026 and given the steep market cap discount (US\$8.5bn) vs. China video-generation model peer Kling post-money valuation of US\$18bn (see our [report](#)) and Z.ai/Zhipu last close at US\$71bn, we view the company's articulated strategy in addressing M3 model competitiveness and imminent H3 multi-modal launch as positive drivers for ARR ramp up that could drive significant room for valuation repair over 2H 2026 (vs. ARR of US\$400mn+ in early June 2026 before M3 launch, at a run-rate likely at half of Zhipu at the mid-year mark 2026). We see a clear positive skew to risk-reward and reiterate Buy.

We continue to see MiniMax as well positioned amongst Chinese AI model companies to capture the significant global TAM growth potential across text/coding, multi-modal, agentic/co-worker (digital labor) and multi-modal generation on the back of its comprehensive multi-modal offerings, strong commercialization capability, AI model per token cost advantages and high organizational efficiency.

Key risks: Weaker-than-expected model performance amid competition in the global foundation model industry; Slower-than-expected path to profit visibility; Weaker-than-expected commercialization capability; risks around IP/content generation; cash burn/self-funding capability; risks around geopolitics under an intensified tech race between the US and China.

Exhibit 1: MiniMax P&L summary

December year-end (US\$ mn)	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
AI-native products	-	1	22	53	149	558	1,622
yoy %			2777%	143%	182%	273%	191%
Open API platform and other AI-based enterprise services	-	3	9	26	151	322	848
yoy %			223%	198%	480%	114%	163%
Revenue	-	3	31	79	300	880	2,470
yoy %			782%	159%	280%	193%	181%
Cost of sales	-	(4)	(27)	(59)	(222)	(666)	(1,625)
Amongst which: Inference cost	-	(4)	(26)	(55)	(181)	(535)	(1,262)
Gross (loss)/profit	-	(1)	4	20	78	214	845
yoy % Buy			538%	437%	289%	174%	295%
GP Margin %		-25%	12%	25%	26%	24%	34%
Selling and distribution expenses	(1)	(23)	(87)	(52)	(75)	(180)	(400)
Administrative expenses	(3)	(8)	(14)	(37)	(60)	(80)	(130)
Research and development expenses	(11)	(70)	(189)	(253)	(468)	(549)	(792)
Amongst which: Training cost	(4)	(47)	(141)	(180)	(360)	(400)	(545)
Operating profit	(14)	(101)	(287)	(321)	(524)	(595)	(477)
Adj. operating profit - non-IFRS	(13)	(98)	(280)	(297)	(455)	(523)	(401)
yoy %		-637%	-186%	-6%	-53%	-15%	23%
OP Margin %		-2831%	-917%	-376%	-152%	-59%	-25%
(Loss)/Profit before tax	(74)	(269)	(465)	(1,872)	(493)	(546)	(428)
Income tax expense	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Net profit/(loss)	(74)	(269)	(465)	(1,872)	(493)	(546)	(428)
Adj. net profit/(loss) - non-IFRS	(12)	(89)	(244)	(251)	(425)	(473)	(352)
yoy %		-633%	-174%	-3%	-69%	-12%	26%
NP Margin %		-2574%	-800%	-317%	-141%	-54%	-14%
GPM		-25%	12%	25%	26%	24%	34%
Adj. OPM		-2831%	-917%	-376%	-152%	-59%	-25%
Adj. NPM		-2574%	-800%	-317%	-141%	-54%	-14%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Valuation bull/bear/base scenarios

Scenarios for valuation	Bear case	Base case	Bull case
	2027E EV/Sales-based	DCF-based	DCF-based, mid-2028E ARR-implied
MiniMax	Applying 10X EV/Sales multiple to 27E revenue of US\$880mn. Bear case valuation implies MiniMax's revenue pool share to decline slightly due to increased competition	Assuming MiniMax's revenue pool share to expand 1.0-1.5ppts p.a. from 2027 to 2030E, reach market share of 9% in 2030E, and 18% EBIT margin. Applying 12% WACC and 2% terminal growth rate (consistent with our coverage).	Bull case valuation assumes MiniMax's revenue pool share to expand 3.6-5.9ppts p.a. from 2027 to 2030E, reaching a total market share of 19% by 2030E. Implies 25X mid-2028E ARR, discounting back using 12% p.a.
Valuation per share (HK\$)	250	860	1350
Valuation (US\$bn)	10	35	54

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Price Target Risks and Methodology - MiniMax Group

We are Buy rated on MiniMax with a 12-month target price of HK\$860. Our valuation is based on DCF valuation, with 12% WACC and 2% terminal growth rate, where we assume 0.2-0.7ppts global subscription+API revenue market share gains p.a. over 2027-30E (reach LT market share of 2.5%).

Key risks: Weaker-than-expected model performance amid the competition in the global foundation model industry; Slower-than-expected path to profit visibility; Weaker-than-expected commercialization capability; risks around IP/content generation; cash burn/self-funding capability; risks around geopolitics under an

intensified tech race between the US and China.

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Reg AC

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Quantum

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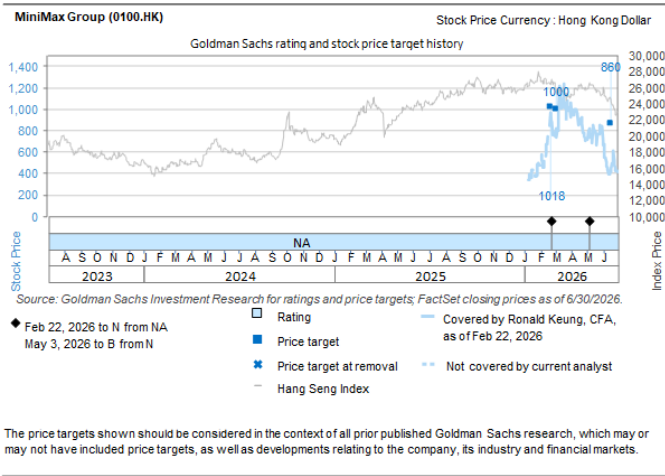
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)

MiniMax Group (0100.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
16-Jun-26	860.00	416.60
03-Mar-26	1,000.00	821.00
22-Feb-26	1,018.00	970.00

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions

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